

Christy Yu

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EDUCATION

Carnegie Mellon University

Masters in Human Computer Interaction, School of Computer Science

4.0 GPA | Aug. 2025 – Aug. 2026

Pittsburgh, PA

UC Santa Barbara

B.S. Computer Science, Statistical Science Minor

3.75 GPA | Aug. 2021 – Jun. 2025

Santa Barbara, CA

SKILLS

Design: Visual UI, Prototyping, Usability Testing, Computer Vision, Data Science, UX Research, Product Strategy, Digital Products, HCI, Figma, Photoshop, Adobe

Languages: Python, C++, Java, HTML/CSS/Javascript, TypeScript, Bash, R, SQL, MATLAB, SAS, Scheme

EXPERIENCE

Designer & Tech Lead

Jan. 2026 - Present

Collier Township (Capstone)

Pittsburgh, PA

- Building AI system for a policy tracker, municipal decision-making and financial budgeting explainer for government and residents to close the communication and trust gap
- Conducted exploratory and usability interviews with 50 residents and government workers on 9 prototypes

Product Design Intern

Jan. 2026 - Present

PLUS Tutoring

Pittsburgh, PA

- Leading end-to-end design process of feature flows for a tutoring platform of **3,000+ students and 500+ tutors**
- Delivered high-fidelity interfaces and published design system documentation to improve session details access for tutors and simplify administrative workload for lead tutors

UI/UX Design Intern

Jun. 2025 - Aug. 2025

Dawdle AI – Anti-procrastination app Startup, featured in KCBS radio

San Francisco, CA

- Designed UI and flows with 30+ screens shipped to App Store launch with **200+ users at 5-star rating**
- Collaborated with CEO and cross-functional engineering team to strategize AI coaching features from beta feedback
- Built 40+ component design system in **Figma** reducing design-to-dev iteration cycles by **25%**

Founding Designer & Frontend Engineer

Oct. 2024 – Aug. 2025

JAFFX — open-source guitar pedal startup

Santa Barbara, CA

- Secured **\$7,500** funding, placed **2nd in 44 teams** at UCSB New Ventures Competition through a compelling storytelling pitch deck.
- Established full brand identity and design system from scratch (logo, typography, color)
- Developed responsive main website (**Next.js & React**) (live at jaffx.audio)

Software Engineer Intern

Jun. 2024 – Aug. 2024

Lorentz Solution

Santa Clara, CA

- Migrated all 44 dynamic libraries from compiler RHEL6 to RHEL78 for PeakView chip-simulation(**Bash scripting**)
- Reduced **10%** in backup storage and production release package by automating library clean-up process
- Executed regression unit tests on circuit simulation cases; analyzed, debugged and troubleshoot on the updated libraries for upcoming release of PeakView software

Data Analyst Research Fellowship

Jan. 2023 – Aug. 2025

Human Wildlife Conflict emLab

Santa Barbara, CA

- 3rd-authored research paper (accepted to **PNAS Nexus**) on climate-driven human-elephant conflict in Namibia
- Built and tuned **habitat suitability machine learning models** with bioclimatic variables and land cover data to explore how climate change drives human-elephant conflict in **R**

PROJECTS

Refract | Anti-deepfake ID Protection ML software

Jan. 2024 - May. 2024

- * Built AI model and frontend app (**Tailwind/Javascript/CSS, Figma**) that disrupts identity-theft deepfakes model training, research poster winning 2nd in annual showcase
- * Cloaked images **disrupts deepfake models by 70%** with no visual difference to the human eye

Other projects on [GitHub](#)